

Fighting disease

The body is constantly under threat from microscopic, disease-causing organisms such as bacteria and viruses (known more commonly as germs). Outer barriers, such as the skin, and an internal immune system stop germs from getting into and multiplying inside the body.

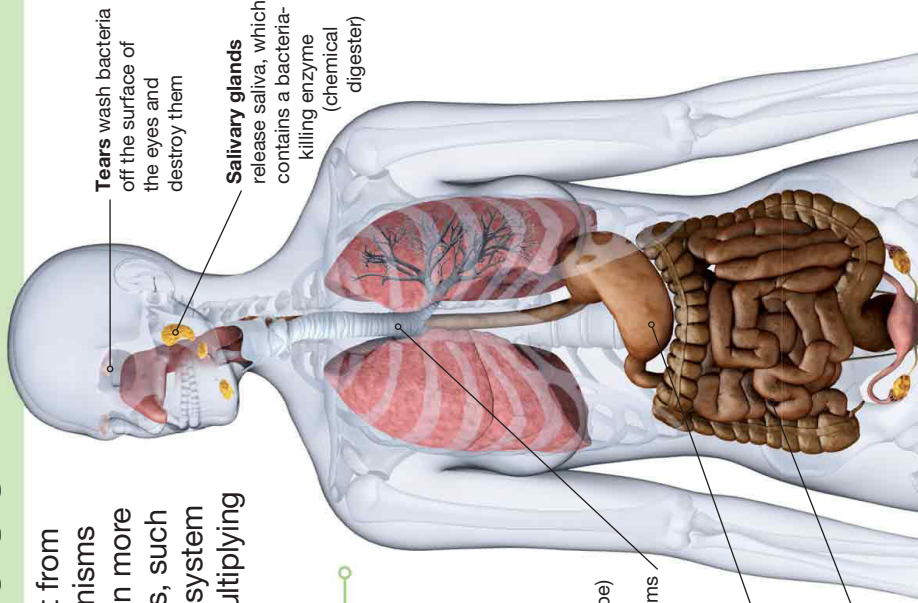
Body barriers

The body has a number of physical defenses to stop infection. Cells lining hollow organs are packed together tightly to stop germs from reaching the tissues beneath them. Special protective fluids, such as mucus, saliva, and gastric juice, help to trap and kill germs.

The **trachea** (windpipe) is lined with sticky mucus that traps germs

The **stomach** releases acidic gastric juice that kills germs in swallowed food

Small intestine enzymes (chemical digesters) destroy bacteria that escape stomach acid



Tears wash bacteria off the surface of the eyes and destroy them

Salivary glands release saliva, which contains a bacteria-killing enzyme (chemical digester)

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